Zubair Idris Aweda

Backend-Focused Full-Stack Engineer

zubairidrisaweda@gmail.com +447426544403 Derby, UK

linkedin.com/in/zubairidrisaweda zubs.github.io github.com/Zubs

SUMMARY

Backend-leaning full-stack engineer with 3+ years building payment systems in PHP/Laravel, Node.js and TypeScript, including microservices running at 99.9% uptime at Stax Payments. First Class BSc Computer Science (University of Wolverhampton, July 2026, 90.44% average). Neo4j Certified Professional who builds with AI coding agents using a spec-first workflow. freeCodeCamp technical author with 443K+ readers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages: PHP, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, SQL, HTML5, CSS3
- Backend: Laravel, Node.js, Express.js, FastAPI, RESTful API design, microservices
- Frontend: Vue 3, React.js, Pinia, Alpine.js
- Databases & Search: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Neo4j (Cypher), Elasticsearch
- Integrations: Stripe, Twilio, Firebase, Mailgun
- Testing, Security & DevOps: Unit and integration testing (TDD), PHPStan, Docker, Git/GitHub, CI/CD, SonarQube, OWASP ZAP, Snyk
- AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, OpenSpec, spec-driven development, MCP servers, GraphRAG
- Methodologies: Agile/Scrum, OOP, MVC

EXPERIENCE

Stax Payments | Mid-Senior Full-Stack Engineer (PHP) | Remote | June 2022 – October 2023
- Designed and built microservices for high-volume payment processing, keeping services at 99.9% uptime.
- Cut developer onboarding time by ~40% by writing internal and public-facing API documentation that became the team's single source of truth.
- Reworked complex data models and ran schema migrations that shipped new features with no downtime or loss of data integrity.
- Enforced unit testing and peer code review on every change, reducing the number of critical bugs reaching production.
- Built accessible, WCAG-compliant interfaces from designers' wireframes.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Node.js, React.js, MySQL, REST APIs, Microservices.

AYU Digital Ltd. | Software Engineer (Contract) | Remote | January 2022 – May 2022
- Built an omnichannel notification engine on Mailgun, Firebase and Twilio that sends thousands of emails, SMS and push notifications a day.
- Implemented authentication flows and mobile number verification with Twilio, reducing fraudulent sign-ups.
- Wrote a custom data export that aggregates relational data into CSV/JSON 10x faster than the previous manual process.
- Built a bulk CSV import with validation, removing most manual data entry for administrators.
- Integrated Stripe for PCI-compliant payment processing.

Stack: PHP, Stripe, Twilio, Firebase, Mailgun.

Humongous.io | Software Engineer (Contract) | Remote | March 2021 – June 2021
- Migrated legacy JavaScript code to TypeScript across the full stack, improving type safety and maintainability.
- Set up automated unit and integration tests that caught regressions before launch.

Stack: TypeScript, JavaScript, CI/CD.

CitonHub | Junior Backend Engineer (Contract) | Remote | November 2020 – January 2021
- Worked with senior engineers to modernise core application logic in Laravel and Vue.js without disrupting existing users.

Stack: PHP, Laravel, Vue.js.

PROJECTS

JCLcheck | jclcheck.xyz | Sole Engineer | Node.js, Express, Vue 3, Vite
- Built a free z/OS JCL checker with a hand-written lexer, parser, AST and rule engine based on the IBM JCL Reference; each problem is reported with its line, column, error code, explanation and suggested fix.
- Published a jclcheck CLI on npm whose SARIF output marks problems on the right lines of GitHub pull requests; built later features spec-first with OpenSpec and Claude Code against a regression suite of exact-diagnostic fixtures.

OWASP SecBank | BSc Dissertation (81%) | Vue 3, Express 5, PostgreSQL
- Built one banking app twice: deliberately vulnerable in all ten OWASP Top 10 categories, then hardened with a specific fix for each (parameterised queries, bcrypt, ownership checks, Joi validation, transfers in transactions with SELECT … FOR UPDATE).
- Evaluated both versions with four manual penetration testers, SonarQube (SAST), OWASP ZAP (DAST) and Snyk (SCA), plus a 24-respondent developer survey.

Miteno | E-commerce (Beta) | Laravel 13, PostgreSQL, Alpine.js
- Built a WhatsApp-ordering storefront for an independent UK clothing brand, with an admin area for products, stock, collections and site content.
- Built it spec-first with Claude Code and OpenSpec: reviewed and merged the first 15 features one pull request at a time, then handed 9 more to the agent in a single unattended run, with Pint, PHPStan and the full test suite as merge gates.

IslamicHub | islamichub.xyz | Co-founder & Lead Engineer | Vue 3, Pinia, Vite
- Built an open-source Islamic education platform with prayer times and Qibla direction, a Zakat calculator using live gold and silver prices, and an inheritance calculator.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, First Class (90.44% average) | University of Wolverhampton | September 2023 – July 2026
- Dissertation: Detecting and Mitigating OWASP Top 10 Threats: Design, Implementation and Security Evaluation of a Database-Driven Web App (81%)
- Selected modules: Object-Oriented Design and Programming (100%), Introductory Programming and Problem Solving (100%), Fundamentals of Computing (100%), Robotic Engineering (96%), Advanced Web Development (94%), Numerical Methods and Concurrency (94%), Complex Systems (86%)

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

Neo4j Certified Professional | Neo4j | *October 2026*
Turbo Mode: Optimizing Productivity with AI Tools & Agents | Unlearn | *October 2026*
The Future Proof Dev: An Intro to AI for Web Developers | Unlearn | *October 2026*
IBM Z and LinuxONE Community Contributor, Level 1 | IBM | *2025*
JavaScript Algorithms and Data Structures | freeCodeCamp
Introduction to Python and Machine Learning | Data Science Nigeria
freeCodeCamp Top Open Source Contributor | *2021–2024*
IBM Z Xplore All-Star

WRITING, SPEAKING & COMMUNITY

Technical Author | freeCodeCamp | 2021 – Present
- Published 15+ articles on backend engineering, Laravel, Node.js, security and algorithms, read 443K+ times and translated into multiple languages.

Conference Speaker | 2022 – 2025
- "Me and AI: Building Securely and Efficiently", DevFest Bletchley Park (2025)
- Observability with Google, DevFest Scotland Online (2024)
- OWASP Top 10 security talk, DevFest London and Ogbomoso (2022, 2023).

IBM Z Student Ambassador | IBM | 2025 – 2026
- Reached Superstar, the programme's highest tier, by promoting mainframe technologies across university channels and online.
- Interviewed for the IBM Z Student Ambassador programme page; featured by the Open Mainframe Project for technical writing; WAVEZ featured my deep-dive on the Mainframe Workload Manager (WLM).

Vice-President & Secretary | Mainframe Student Society, University of Wolverhampton | 2025 – 2026
- Organised weekly technical meet-ups and events, including "Mainframe and Computer Science" for CS students, and ran society operations, outreach and social media.

Mentee, Educational Content & Advocacy | Mainframe Open Education, LFX Mentorship | Summer 2026
- Selected for the Linux Foundation mentorship to write technical content for mainframe beginners.